

A SIMPLE ROADMAP

Starting & Growing Dallas Home and Office Cleaning

Hi Michelle — this is everything I'd think about when starting and building out a business like yours, laid out simply and in order. Some of it is stuff you'll handle yourself (or with an accountant), and some of it is stuff I can help with directly. I've marked each one so it's clear who does what. Nothing here needs to happen overnight — think of it as a map, not a deadline.

Phase 1 — Business Foundations

The legal and financial groundwork. This part isn't design work, so it's mostly on you (or a local accountant/attorney) — but I'm happy to point you toward resources.

Step	Who Handles It
Choose a business structure (sole proprietor vs. LLC) — an LLC protects your personal assets if something goes wrong on a job	You
Register your business name with the state (LLC) or county (DBA for sole proprietor)	You
Get a free EIN (Employer ID Number) from the IRS website — needed for banking and taxes	You
Open a dedicated business bank account — keeping funds separate protects you legally	You
Register for a Texas Sales Tax Permit through the Texas Comptroller	You
Check Dallas's local business license requirements	You
Get general liability insurance — most commercial clients expect at least \$1M coverage	You
Consider a janitorial bond — many commercial clients require one, even though Texas doesn't mandate it	You

These steps protect you and are usually quick — an accountant can often set up items 1–5 in a single afternoon.

Phase 2 — Brand Identity

Right now there's no logo yet — this is the foundation everything else (website, business cards, van signage) will be built on.

Step	Who Handles It
Design a logo that reflects the business	Me
Choose a simple color palette and font pairing	Me
Design a business card / flyer for in-person leads	Me
Optional: van decal or uniform design, once the logo is set	Me

Phase 3 — Online Presence

This is where most new customers will actually find and evaluate the business.

Step	Who Handles It
Finish the homepage design (mockup already started)	Me
Set up a real domain name (e.g. dallashomeandofficecleaning.com) and hosting	Me + You
Claim and optimize a Google Business Profile — this is what makes the business show up on Google Maps	Me + You
Keep the Facebook page active and consistent with the new branding	You
Add a working contact / quote-request form to the site	Me

Phase 4 — Day-to-Day Tools

The practical side of running jobs once bookings start coming in.

Step	Who Handles It
Pick an invoicing/payments tool (e.g. Square, QuickBooks)	You
Pick a scheduling tool for booking and reminders	You
Stock core supplies and equipment	You

Phase 5 — Getting Your First Customers

Once the foundation is in place, this is how the phone actually starts ringing.

Step	Who Handles It
Ask every happy client for a Google review — this builds trust fast	You
Post before/after photos and updates on Facebook regularly	You
Set up a simple referral incentive (e.g. discount for referring a friend)	You
Share the business in local Dallas Facebook groups and Nextdoor	You

Phase 6 — Ongoing Growth Services

Everything above gets the business open and visible. These are optional, ongoing services for once things are running and you're ready to actively grow — think of this as a menu, not a checklist. We'd pick and choose based on budget and what's actually moving the needle.

Step	Who Handles It
Full WordPress website — a real, editable site (replacing the static mockup), built to add pages, photos, and updates yourself over time	Me

SEO retainer — ongoing keyword targeting and on-page work to keep climbing in Google search results, not just a one-time setup	Me
Social media management — a regular posting calendar, captions, and engagement on Facebook & Instagram so the page stays active	Me
Graphic design — ongoing flyers, seasonal promos, social graphics, and printed materials beyond the initial logo/business card	Me
Google & Facebook ads management — paid ads to bring in leads faster while organic SEO builds up in the background	Me
Monthly performance reporting — a simple summary of website traffic, leads, and where they're coming from	Me

None of this needs to start on day one — most businesses add these in gradually as bookings grow and there's budget to reinvest.

Where to Start

If it's easier to think about it in order: get the legal basics done first (Phase 1), then let's lock in the logo and brand (Phase 2) since the website and everything visual depends on it, then launch the site and Google profile together (Phase 3). Phases 4 and 5 can happen alongside all of that — they're ongoing, not one-time steps. Phase 6 is there for whenever you're ready to actively grow rather than just get set up.

Whenever you're ready, tell me your budget and what matters most to you right now, and I'll help you prioritize the exact order that makes sense.